

# ICE raid tactics at issue in shooting

TikTok streamer's car was boxed in by agents. They say he tried to ram them.

By RUBEN VIVES, JAMES QUEALLY, RICHARD WINTON, BRITTNY MEJIA AND RACHEL URANGA

In a dense South Los Angeles neighborhood, TikTok streamer Carlitos Ricardo Parias revved his engine but was pinned in by the vehicles of federal agents on all sides.

Video taken of the incident Tuesday morning — in which Parias and a deputy U.S. marshal were shot — captures the moment he tries to escape, spinning his car tires, and sending smoke billowing into the air, as agents stand just several feet away.

"Shoot him with a pepper ball," an agent yells out.

Then 11 gunshots ring out.

"*Me dieron un balazo*," Parias can be heard yelling. They shot me.

The shooting is one of several during the Trump administration's crackdown on unauthorized immigrants where agents have become increasingly aggressive in carrying out operations. In Southern California and Chicago, where the operations have been most intense, agents have shot at suspects in cars, alleging that they were rammed, were hit by the vehicle or were in danger. In one case, a man was killed.

Federal officials accuse Parias, a 44-year-old well-known TikTok streamer of local breaking news, of ramming his car into agents' vehicles after they boxed him in and tried to arrest him during an immigration enforcement operation. He is being charged with assault on a federal officer. It wasn't his first run-in with immigration agents.

In June, agents stopped Parias in a traffic stop, according to the Los Angeles Police Department. They pulled over the car he was in because it blew through a red light and appeared to be following them. Video that day captured Parias wearing a black press vest, handcuffed and surrounded by agents as he writhed in pain, holding his leg. Agents later let him hobble away as a crowd recorded and said, "Let him go."

Parias and the deputy marshal remained hospitalized Wednesday. Authorities say the officer was struck by a ricocheting bullet.

[See ICE, A6]



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

**ANDREW** Fortner, left, Patryk Swietek, Ryan Cherlin and Josh Rudin run Cohost Co., which manages 120 short-term rentals around Joshua Tree. Swietek says of the rental market, "During COVID, it was bonkers."

# Desert rental market dries up

Operators of vacation lodgings in Joshua Tree exit after a boom

By ALEX WIGGLESWORTH

**JOSHUA TREE, Calif.** — Many Angelenos dreamed about buying cheap land in the desert during the COVID-19 pandemic; Emmanuel Ruggiero actually did it.

On his plot in Joshua Tree, the software engineer built a home specifically as a short-term rental — part of a craze that saw investors seeking to cash in on people fleeing the stress and contagion of cities to isolate in more-remote locales. He equipped his modern cabin

with 16-foot ceilings, a swim spa and a private nine-hole golf course.

Now, after two years as a top-rated Airbnb host, Ruggiero no longer wants to deal with the stress of managing a rental three hours away. He is hoping to sell his home for about \$200,000 less than its appraised value when he first finished construction.

"If I had bought stocks instead of putting the money into the house I built, I probably would have made more," he said.

He's far from alone. Operators are exiting the short-term rental market in the

high desert east of Los Angeles. This year, the Joshua Tree area has seen a drop in average available listings for the first time since the pandemic drove the number to record highs — with 3,449 to date, compared with 3,606 at the same time last year, according to data from AirDNA.

Some are selling at a potential loss in a real estate market that has cooled since the dizzying heights of 2020 and 2021. Others are seeking long-term tenants to offset their mortgages as they wait to see whether home sales pick up.

The shift may reflect a market correction after the saturation of vacation rentals became unsustainable and some inexperienced investors underestimated the difficulty and expense of managing properties, according to interviews with more than a dozen Realtors, property managers and investors. It may also be driven by a post-pandemic-emergency drop in tourism that has become more acute amid economic uncertainty and a volatile political climate, observers said.

Meanwhile, those who [See Rentals, A7]

# DEMOCRATS' GENERATION GAP

Nancy Pelosi's most serious primary challenge is coming amid a growing push for a power shift

By Kevin Rector, Ana Ceballos and Seema Mehta

REPORTING FROM SAN FRANCISCO



**JOSH EDELSON** For The Times (left); **LEA SUZUKI** AP

**STATE SEN.** Scott Wiener announced his run for Rep. Nancy Pelosi's seat.



liver for San Francisco in Congress."

Wiener's announcement — which leaked in part last week — caught some political observers off guard, given Wiener had for years seemed resigned to run for Pelosi's seat only once she stepped aside. But it stunned few, given how squarely it fit within the broader political moment facing the Democratic Party.

In recent years, a long-simmering reckoning over generational power has exploded into the political forefront as members of the party's old guard have increasingly been accused of holding on too long, and to their party's detriment.

Long-serving liberal Supreme Court Justice Ruth Bader Ginsburg ruffled many Democratic feathers by declining to step down during Barack Obama's presidency despite be- [See Pelosi, A5]

# A wrecking ball at the White House

By DARLENE SUPERVILLE

**WASHINGTON** — The White House started tearing down part of the East Wing, the traditional base of operations for the first lady, to build President Trump's \$250-million ballroom despite lacking approval for construction from the federal agency that oversees such projects.

Dramatic photos of the demolition work that began Monday showed construction equipment tearing into the East Wing façade and windows and other building parts in tatters on the ground.

Some reporters watched from a park near the Treasury Department, which is



ANDREW HARNIK Getty Images

**THE FACADE** of the East Wing of the White House is demolished as part of a plan to build a ballroom.

next to the East Wing.

On Wednesday, the New York Times reported that the plan now called for the demolition of the entire East Wing and that the teardown should be completed by Sunday. Citing a source, The Times said it marks an escalation over earlier plans for the ballroom.

Trump announced the start of construction in a social media post and referenced the work while hosting 2025 college baseball champions Louisiana State University and LSU-Shreveport in the East Room. He noted the work was happening "right behind us."

"We have a lot of construction going on, which you might hear periodically," [See Ballroom, A6]

# U.S. attack on boat in Pacific widens war on drugs, draws rebuke

By KATE LINTHICUM, ANA CEBALLOS AND PATRICK J. McDONNELL

**MEXICO CITY** — The United States has widened its military campaign against alleged drug traffickers in Latin America, announcing on Wednesday that its forces had struck a boat purportedly smuggling narcotics off the Pacific coast of Colombia.

It was the eighth alleged drug vessel bombed by the U.S. in recent weeks, and the first attacked in the Pacific Ocean.

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth said the airstrike killed two people, bringing the death toll in the attacks to 34. He said the vessel was "known by our intelligence" to be carrying narcotics, but did not provide evidence of those claims.

In a short video clip posted on X by Hegseth, a

# Trump's orders to troops revisited

Judges take rare step of rethinking ruling on the president's use of military on U.S. soil.

By SONJA SHARP

Three of the country's most powerful judges met in Pasadena on Wednesday for a rare conclave that could rewrite the legal framework for President Trump's expansive deployment of troops to cities across the United States.

The move to flood Los Angeles with thousands of federalized troops over the objection of state and local leaders shocked the country back in June. Nearly five months later, such military interventions have become almost routine.

But whether the deployments can expand — and how long they can continue — relies on a novel reading of an obscure subsection of the U.S. code that determines the president's ability to dispatch the National Guard and federal service members. That code has been under heated debate in courts across the country.

Virtually all of those cases have turned on the 9th Circuit's decision in June. The judges found that the law in question requires "a great level of deference" to the president to decide when protest flashes into rebellion, and whether boots on the ground are warranted in response.

On Wednesday, the same three-judge panel — Jennifer Sung of Portland, Ore., Eric D. Miller of Seattle and Mark J. Bennett of Honolulu — took the rare move of reviewing it, signaling a willingness to dramatically rewrite the terms of engagement that have underpinned Trump's deployments.

"I guess the question is, why is a couple of hundred people engaging in disorderly conduct and throwing things at a building over the course of two days of comparable severity of a rebellion?" said Miller, an appointee from Trump's first term. "Violence is used to thwart the enforcement of federal law all the time. This happens every day."

The question he posed has riven the judicial system, splitting district judges from appellate panels and the Pacific Coast from the Midwest. Some of Trump's judicial appointees have broken sharply with their colleagues on the matter, including on the 9th Circuit. [See Troops, A7]

## Auto titan's path to LAPD power

Galpin Motors' police ties spark doubt about new commissioner's independence. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

## EV sales reach a record in state

Californians scooped up zero-emission and plug-in hybrid vehicles before federal tax credits expired. **CALIFORNIA, B3**

## Financial firm bets on downtown

Banc of California's expansion to high-rise will nearly double its office space and boost its presence. **BUSINESS, A9**

## Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 75/56. **B6**

